



Gaming laptops

After the Razer Blade, Gigabyte's Aorus becomes the world's most powerful and lightest gaming laptop <http://dgit.in/AorusGamingLaptop>



It was the Higgs Boson

Recent study suggests that the particle discovered in 2012 at LHC was indeed the Higgs Boson <http://dgit.in/HiggsBosonLHC>



PERFORMANCE AND DESIGN

DELL

Inspiron 14 7437

The Dell manages to redeem itself in the design department somewhat. The overall shape of the device is very similar to the MacBooks that have inspired so many laptops in their time, but the design is sufficiently different to stand out. The black Dell logo on the lid looks particularly nice.

In terms of pure numbers, the performance is average, with battery life standing out as the best in class.

The keyboard and touchpad are basic and functional and do their job. The backlight performance is not very consistent though. We found that a bright screen in a dark room tended to obscure the backlit keys.

The contrast ratio of the screen was terrible and white levels atrocious, which made the movie watching experience quite dull. The speakers are quite good however; loud, if a bit harsh.

ASUS

S400CA

Our performance scores very accurately reflected the strengths and weaknesses of the Ivy Bridge platform here.

The S400CA managed a very decent showing in 3DMark's Ice Storm benchmark, a CPU intensive one we might add, and almost every other CPU benchmark available.

At the same time, the GPU scores and PCMark 8 scores were the lowest we recorded. The battery life was also terrible at only 132 minutes, but this isn't the worst news. The maximum recorded temperatures shocked us, we saw 92°C on full load. This is definitely not one for your lap, if you value your skin that is.

The screen was also terrible, with a measured contrast ratio of 80:1 and if anything, the white saturation was even worse, with 9 out of 12 boxes visible (lagom.nl). A better screen and a Haswell CPU are desperately required.

ACER

Aspire S7 392

If ever there was an Ultrabook for show, this has to be it. The S7 is slim and sleek like no other Ultrabook we've seen. The design and build quality exudes quality and we particularly liked the Gorilla Glass lid with its glowing Acer logo.

The keyboard and touchpad are a bit of an issue and are neither as comfortable nor as responsive as we would like, but if you're buying this device you're not doing it for the functionality, we hope.

The screen is lovely, the colours are vibrant, a tad oversaturated and very punchy and the touch-screen a joy to use. Performance figures are average, but that's to be expected.

Speaking of temperatures, the device did touch 79 degrees, but the exhaust is efficiently expended out the back, ensuring that the device itself doesn't get too hot, keeping your laps safe.

TOSHIBA

Portégé Z30t-A

This is quite possibly the best laptop in this comparison. It's the very definition of a laptop, it's light, ergonomic, well-designed, boasts of the best screen in this test, has the best laptop keyboard we've tested and features a matte screen.

There were a few issues we faced with regard to the touchpad's keys, which were stiff, the less than stellar touch-screen response and the low output of the speakers.

These aspects could definitely have used some work, but they're not deal-breakers by any stretch of the imagination.

More than even the keyboard however, it's the screen that stands out. Movie watching was a pleasure on the device and if only the speakers had been better, this would have been a great multimedia device.

Sadly, the asking price is very high for what's on offer.

Performance

PCMark 8.....	2155
3DMark Ice Storm.....	40197
Peacekeeper.....	4294
Cinebench R15.....	233cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	13fps
Contrast Ratio.....	101:1
Max. Temp.....	74 °C
Battery Life.....	253 minutes

Performance

PCMark 8.....	1838
3DMark Ice Storm.....	42729
Peacekeeper.....	3995
Cinebench R15.....	254cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	9.6fps
Contrast Ratio.....	80:1
Max. Temp.....	92 °C
Battery Life.....	132 minutes

Performance

PCMark 8.....	2145
3DMark Ice Storm.....	41535
Peacekeeper.....	4451
Cinebench R15.....	230cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	13.1fps
Contrast Ratio.....	550:1
Max. Temp.....	79 °C
Battery Life.....	200 minutes

Performance

PCMark 8.....	1959
3DMark Ice Storm.....	36194
Peacekeeper.....	4137
Cinebench R15.....	233cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	10.5fps
Contrast Ratio.....	686:1
Max. Temp.....	74 °C
Battery Life.....	223 minutes